

State of the Web 2020–2025: HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols, and Security

Data source: HTTP Archive State of the Web report.

Time range: **January 2020 – March 2026.**

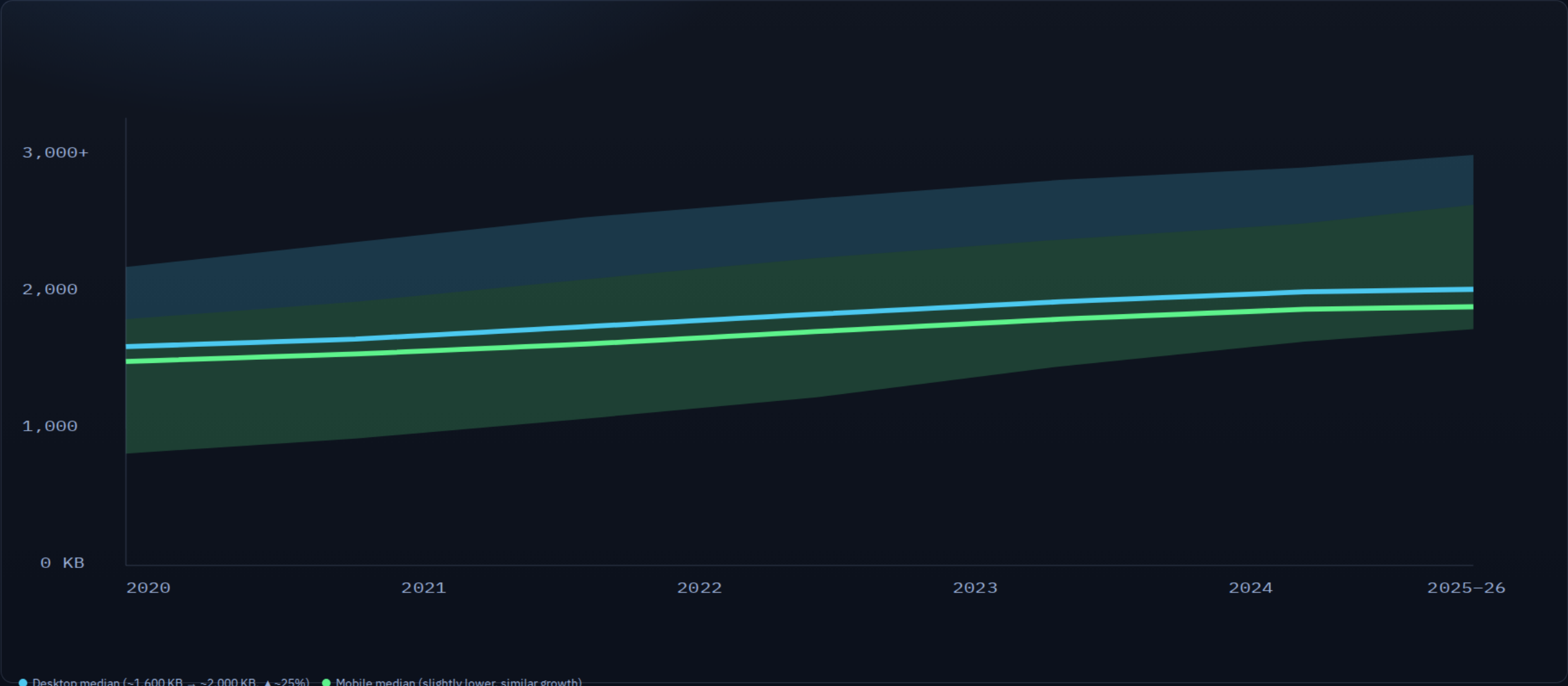
Audience: web performance engineers and front-end architects evaluating infrastructure trends.

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



Sharp inflection appears in mid-2022, then both series plateau near 16M desktop and 12.5M mobile from mid-2023 onward.

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop



75th-percentile desktop pages now exceed 4,000 KB, indicating a substantial heavy-page tail.

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

Median Requests / Page

76 desktop

71 mobile • both up ~3% since 2020

Median TCP Connections / Page

12.0 desktop

11.0 mobile • down from ~15 in 2020

Interpretation

Requests rise while connection count falls, consistent with HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 multiplexing efficiency.



HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

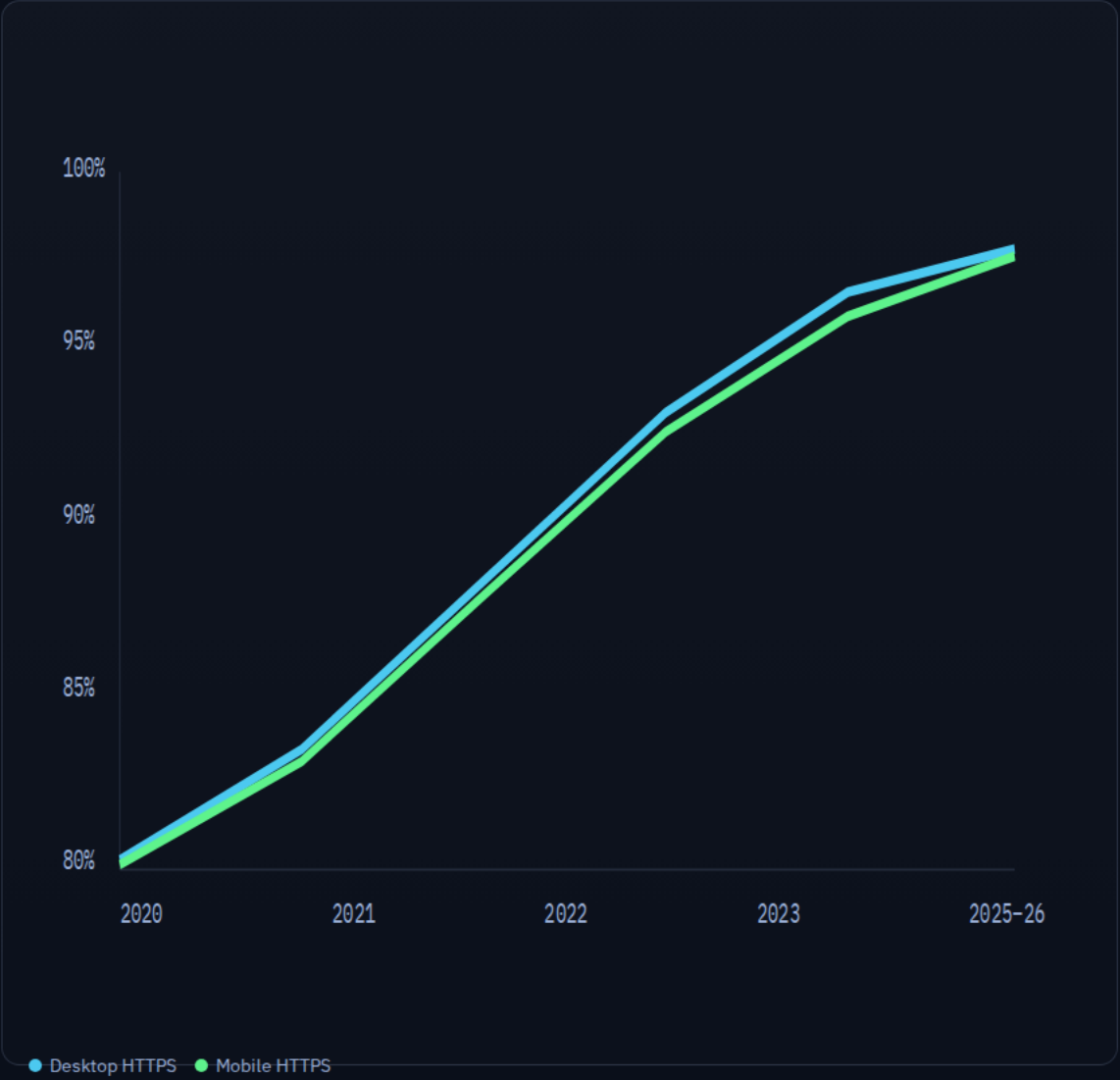
Current HTTPS request share

99%+

Desktop: 99.2%

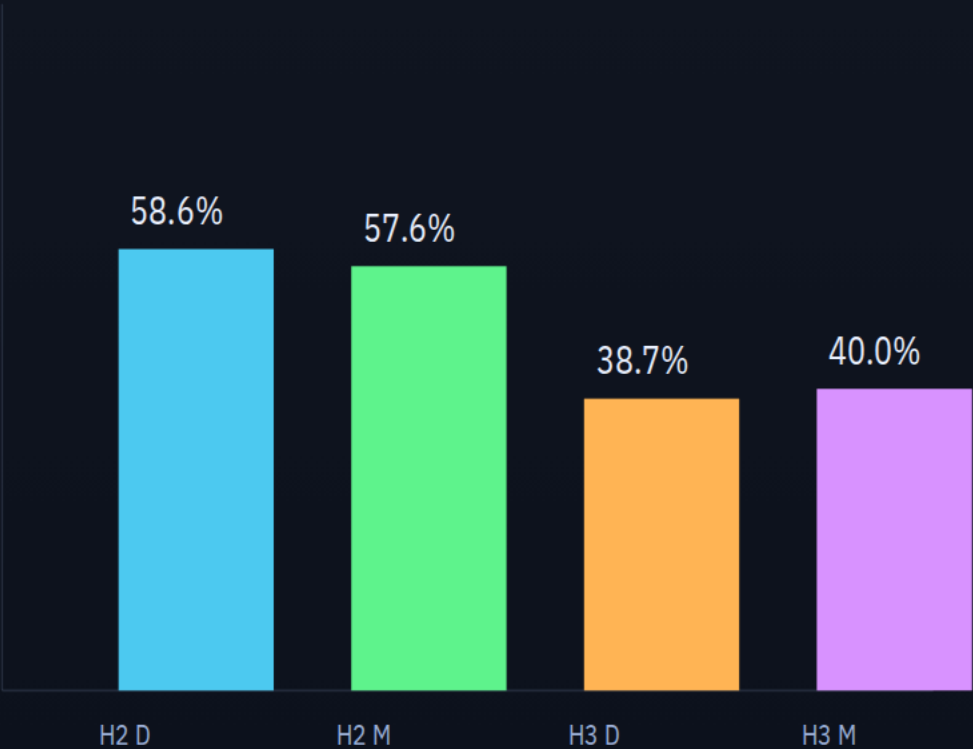
Mobile: 99.1%

Increase from 2020 baseline: ~19–20 percentage points.

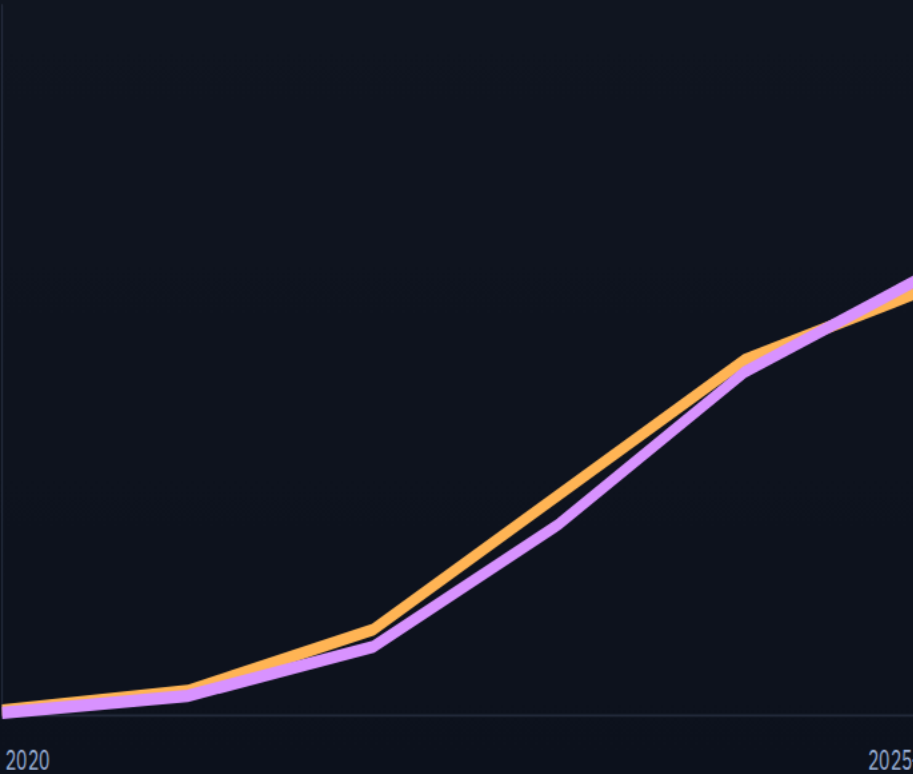


Plaintext HTTP is effectively absent from mainstream web traffic.

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%



HTTP/2 growth is now modest, while HTTP/3 support has moved from near-zero to ~40%.



- HTTP/3 metric is support, not first-request usage.
- Fresh Chrome instances often start with HTTP/2 before Alt-Svc discovery.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020



Why it matters

font-display reduces FOIT risk by controlling fallback/swap behavior during web font loading.

Current baseline

40–42%

Desktop up 14.9% since 2020; mobile up 61.0%.

Gap

More than half of pages still do not use this property, leaving render performance gains on the table.

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

- **Page weight keeps rising:** desktop median moved from ~1,600 KB to ~2,000 KB (about +25%).
- **HTTPS is baseline infrastructure:** 99.2% desktop and 99.1% mobile request share.
- **HTTP/3 is the fastest-moving protocol metric:** support now at 38.7% desktop and 40.0% mobile.
- **Connection efficiency improved:** median TCP connections fell from ~15 to 12 (desktop) and 11 (mobile) despite higher request counts.
- **Font-display remains a practical optimization gap:** adoption is 40.1% desktop and 42.5% mobile.

Call to action

Benchmark your own properties against these baselines (weight, requests, protocol mix, HTTPS share, and font-display usage) and prioritize optimizations where your deltas are largest.